

The OBX Rental Owner's Operations Kit

RUN YOUR OUTER BANKS RENTAL LIKE A PRO

Checklists · templates · a seasonal storm calendar · vendor sheets — everything to keep a coastal rental clean, booked, and out of trouble.

By OBX Lot Solutions

Outer Banks, NC · (252) 564-8717 · obxsecondhomehub.com

START HERE

How to use this kit

This kit turns the hundred little jobs of running an Outer Banks rental into a system you can hand to anyone. Two ways to use it:

- ☐ **Print it.** The checklists and sheets are made to print and check off — laminate the turnover list and reuse it.
- ☐ **Copy it.** Paste the templates into your booking platform's saved messages and your own docs, then make them yours.

Built by a local crew that cleans, washes, and watches OBX homes for a living — so the calendar, storm timing, and salt-and-humidity tasks are tuned to the Banks, not the mainland.

What's inside

- **Turnover & Cleaning Checklist.** Room-by-room changeover list.
- **Guest Message Templates.** Five fill-in-the-blank messages.
- **Seasonal Maintenance & Storm Calendar.** Month-by-month for the OBX.
- **Vendor & Emergency Contact Sheet.** One-page who-to-call.
- **Supply & Inventory Par List.** Never run out again.
- **Damage & Incident Protocol.** Leak/storm/guest steps.
- **Owner's Property Binder.** Your home's master sheet.
- **Pricing & Calendar Quick-Guide.** Protect your margin.

01 · Turnover & Cleaning Checklist

The room-by-room list your cleaner follows on every changeover. Print one per turnover, or laminate it and check off with a marker. Nothing gets missed between guests.

Kitchen

- ☐ Dishes washed, dishwasher empty, nothing in sink
- ☐ Counters, stovetop, microwave, sink wiped & sanitized
- ☐ Fridge emptied of guest food; wiped; set to temp
- ☐ Coffee maker cleaned, filters/pods restocked
- ☐ Trash & recycling out; fresh liners in every bin
- ☐ Floor swept & mopped
- ☐ Starter supplies set: dish soap, sponge, paper towels, trash bags

Bathrooms

- ☐ Toilet, shower/tub, sink scrubbed & sanitized
- ☐ Mirrors & fixtures wiped streak-free
- ☐ Fresh towels set (per max occupancy + spares)
- ☐ Toilet paper: 1 on roll + 2 spares per bath
- ☐ Starter soap, shampoo restocked
- ☐ Hair & debris cleared from drains
- ☐ Floor washed

Bedrooms & living

- ☐ All beds stripped, fresh linens, hospital corners
- ☐ Mattress protectors checked for stains
- ☐ Pillows fluffed; throw blankets folded
- ☐ Surfaces dusted; under beds & sofa checked for items
- ☐ Windows/sliders cleaned; tracks clear of sand
- ☐ Floors vacuumed/swept & mopped
- ☐ Remotes present & working; batteries OK
- ☐ Sofa cushions reset; sleeper sofa made if applicable

Whole-house & final pass

- ☐ HVAC set to guest-ready temp; filter checked
- ☐ All lights working; replace dead bulbs
- ☐ Wi-Fi working; network & password card displayed
- ☐ Exterior: deck swept, furniture set, grill clean, no trash
- ☐ Outdoor shower & entry sand-free

- ☐ Lockbox/smart-lock code set for incoming guest
- ☐ Welcome book & house rules in place
- ☐ Walk-through photos taken (date-stamped) before you leave

Pro move: take date-stamped photos of every room at the end of each turnover. It proves the home's condition at check-in if a guest claims pre-existing damage — and it's your fastest path on an insurance or platform claim.

MODULE 02

02 • Guest Message Templates

Copy these into your booking platform's saved messages or your email. Replace anything in [BRACKETS]. Keep them warm, short, and clear — guests skim.

1 • Booking confirmation

Hi [GUEST], you're all set for [DATES] at [PROPERTY NAME]! We're so glad you picked our place for your Outer Banks trip. I'll send full check-in details 48 hours before arrival. Quick question so we can prep: what's the occasion, and roughly what time do you expect to arrive on [CHECK-IN DATE]? — [YOUR NAME]

2 • Check-in instructions (send 48h before)

Hi [GUEST]! Check-in is after [TIME] on [DATE]. Address: [ADDRESS]. Door code: [CODE] (works from [TIME]). Parking: [INSTRUCTIONS]. Wi-Fi: [NETWORK] / [PASSWORD]. The welcome book inside has everything — trash day, beach access, AC tips, and our number if anything comes up. Checkout is [TIME] on [DATE]. Have a great trip! — [YOUR NAME] • [PHONE]

3 • House rules (in listing + welcome book)

To keep the home great for everyone: no smoking anywhere on the property; no parties or events; quiet hours [TIME]–[TIME]; max occupancy [N]; pets [POLICY]; please rinse off sand at the outdoor shower before coming in; take trash to [LOCATION] on [DAY]; and never put anything but TP down the toilets (septic). Thanks for treating the home like your own!

4 • Mid-stay check-in (day after arrival)

Hi [GUEST], hope you're settling in and the weather's cooperating! Everything working the way you need? If anything's not perfect, tell me now and I'll fix it fast. Local tip: [RESTAURANT/ACTIVITY]. Enjoy! — [YOUR NAME]

5 • Checkout + review request (morning of checkout)

Thanks for staying with us, [GUEST]! Just a few checkout steps: start the dishwasher, bag trash and leave it [LOCATION], turn AC to [TEMP], and lock up — the code locks behind you. Safe travels! If we earned it, a quick review means the world to a small local team, and we'd love to host you again. — [YOUR NAME]

MODULE 03

03 · Seasonal Maintenance & Storm Calendar

OBX-specific. Salt, humidity, and storms set the schedule here — not the mainland calendar. Pair the spring and fall items with a deep clean, and book exterior work before peak season.

Jan–Feb	Off-season	Winter check for freeze/leaks; run water; confirm heat holding; inspect for storm damage; deep-clean & maintenance projects while vacant.
March	Pre-season prep	HVAC service & new filters; test all appliances; restock supplies; exterior soft wash (salt & algae); refresh linens/towels.
April	Open up	Deep clean; pressure-wash decks; check outdoor shower & grill; smoke/CO detectors & batteries; confirm Wi-Fi & locks.
May	Season start	Gutter check; pest control; inspect roof & flashing; stock first-aid & supplies; verify guest welcome book is current.
Jun–Aug	Peak + hurricane watch	Tight turnovers; weekly exterior tidy; HVAC filter monthly; keep a storm kit ready; pre-/post-storm checks (see storm steps).
September	Peak hurricane	Highest storm risk — keep the storm checklist handy; secure loose items between guests; document condition often.
October	Wind-down	Post-season deep clean; deck/fence seal; chimney/fireplace check; HVAC service before cold.
Nov–Dec	Close & holidays	Holiday lighting (book early); winterize if closing; drain outdoor lines; freeze protection; final exterior wash.

Named-storm quick steps (off-island owners)

- ☐ Secure or stow all loose items (furniture, grill, planters, trash cans)
- ☐ Close shutters / install panels on big windows
- ☐ Shut off main water; set HVAC to safe hold
- ☐ Move valuables up; unplug electronics
- ☐ Confirm sump pump + battery backup
- ☐ After: local post-storm check with dated photos; mitigate water within 24–48h; file claims fast

Can't be here for storms? A local home-watch service handles pre- and post-storm checks and sends photo proof. See obxsecondhomehub.com.

MODULE 04

04 · Vendor & Emergency Contact Sheet

Fill this in once and keep a copy in the home and with anyone who helps run it. In an emergency, no one should be hunting for a number.

Cleaner / turnover

Handyman

HVAC

Plumber

Electrician

Home-watch / property check

Pest control

Landscaper

Pool / hot-tub service

Locksmith

Preferred contractor

Power company

Water / utilities

Internet provider

Insurance agent + policy #

**Nearest hospital / urgent
care**

Non-emergency police

MODULE 05

05 · Supply & Inventory Par List

Your par list — the minimum on hand at all times. Restock to par at each turnover so you never get the 'we're out of...' message.

Toilet paper	1 on roll + 2 spares / bath	Bath
Paper towels	2 rolls min	Kitchen
Trash bags	Full box (kitchen + small)	Under sink
Dish soap / detergent	1 each, backup	Kitchen
Dishwasher pods	Enough for the stay	Kitchen
Hand soap	Full + 1 spare / sink	Baths
Shampoo / body wash	Starter + spare	Baths
Laundry detergent	Enough for guest loads	Laundry
Sponges / dish cloths	2+ fresh	Kitchen
Light bulbs (common sizes)	2-3 each	Closet
HVAC filters	2 on hand	Closet
Batteries (AA/AAA/9V)	Pack each	Drawer
First-aid kit	Stocked	Kitchen
Beach basics (optional)	Per your listing	Closet

MODULE 06

06 • Damage & Incident Protocol

When something goes wrong, follow the order: protect people, stop the damage, document, then claim. Speed and documentation save you the most money.

Water leak / flood

- ☐ Shut off the main water supply immediately
- ☐ Move guests/valuables away from water
- ☐ Photograph everything before cleanup (date-stamped)
- ☐ Call plumber + (if needed) water-mitigation pro — mold starts in 24-48h
- ☐ Notify insurer; start the claim with photos
- ☐ Log the timeline (when found, actions taken)

Storm damage

- ☐ Confirm it's safe to enter
- ☐ Photograph all damage before touching anything
- ☐ Tarp/secure to prevent further damage (keep receipts)
- ☐ File claim fast with dated before/after photos
- ☐ Arrange repairs; keep all documentation

Guest issue / damage

- ☐ Respond calmly and fast — most issues are fixable
- ☐ Document with photos + written notes
- ☐ For damage: compare to your check-in photos
- ☐ Use the platform's resolution/AirCover-style process with evidence
- ☐ Keep communication on-platform and professional

This is general guidance, not legal or insurance advice — always follow your own policy and platform rules.

07 · Owner's Property Binder

The single source of truth for your home. Fill it in once; update when something changes. Anyone running the property should be able to answer any question from this page.

Property

Property name

Address

Beds / baths / max
occupancy

Parking

Trash day & location

Beach access

Septic or sewer?

Systems & shutoffs

Water main shutoff
(location)

Electrical panel (location)

HVAC type & filter size

Water heater (type/location)

Wi-Fi network / password

Smart-lock / alarm codes

Outdoor shower / hot tub
notes

Quirks & notes

Anything a guest or helper needs to know — the tricky lock, the breaker that trips, the perfect AC setting:

08 · Pricing & Calendar Quick-Guide

Plain-English notes to protect your margin. Not financial advice — your numbers depend on your home, costs, and goals.

OBX seasonality (rough shape)

- ☐ Peak: mid-June through mid-August + holiday weeks — your highest nightly rates, Saturday-to-Saturday weeks are common.
- ☐ Shoulder: April-May and September-October — strong value; September can rival summer with fewer crowds (watch hurricane risk).
- ☐ Off-season: November-March — lower rates, longer stays, snowbird/monthly potential; some owners close up.

Protect your margin

- ☐ Set your cleaning fee to actually cover turnover cost — don't subsidize it to look cheaper.
- ☐ Use minimum-night stays in peak (weekly) to cut turnover cost and wear.
- ☐ Build maintenance + a reserve into your annual math — coastal homes cost more to keep.
- ☐ Price storm-season flexibility (clear cancellation terms) so you're not eating losses.

Margin tip: the costs that quietly eat OBX rental profit are turnovers, exterior upkeep (salt & algae), and storm/vacancy surprises. Systemize the first, schedule the second, and insure/watch the third — this kit covers all three.

ONE MORE THING

Want it hands-off?

Running the systems in this kit still takes time on the ground. If you're out of state — or just want your weekends back — the same local team behind this kit can do the hands-on work:

- **Home watch** — scheduled checks with a photo report every visit.
- **Pre- & post-storm checks** — we prep and document so your claim is fast.
- **Soft washing & exterior care** — keep salt and algae off the house.
- **Turnovers, junk removal & cleanups** — one reliable local for all of it.

Learn more or get a free quote at **obxsecondhomehub.com** · (252) 564-8717.
Mention you have the Ops Kit.